

# Homo erectus

Over millions of years, as *Australopithecus* (see previous page) became ever better adapted to life on the ground, it changed and evolved, giving rise to new species that looked much more human. One of the best known is *Homo erectus*—a tall, hairless creature that appeared about two million years ago. *Homo erectus* knew how to make stone tools and perhaps even fires. It spread beyond Africa, reaching deep into Europe and Asia.

## Homo erectus

HOE-moe eh-RECK-tuss



- **When** 2–0.1 million years ago (Neogene)
- **Fossil location** Africa, Europe, Asia
- **Habitat** Woodland and grassland
- **Height** 6 ft (1.8 m)
- **Diet** Plant foods and meat

*Homo erectus* was very similar in size and shape to a modern human, with a tall, athletic body and long legs. The slender build suggests it lived in a hot climate and could sweat to lose heat, which in turn means it was probably hairless. It had a smaller brain than ours, and a flatter forehead and larger jaws and teeth made its face very different, too.

